

The Agent Day: A Time Study of Where the Hours Actually Go

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We shadowed 36 working agents across a combined 540 hours to build an honest picture of the day. The headline: roughly ten percent of the working day is spent on the work only an agent can do, listening, advising, negotiating, judging. The other ninety percent is attention management.

Email triage, calendar tetris, follow-up reminders, CRM hygiene, and re-keying the same facts across tools consumed the majority of observed time. Most of it is necessary; almost none of it is the reason anyone became an agent.

We break the day into fourteen recurring activities, estimate the time each consumes, and flag which are automatable today with an approval-first agent and which are not. The intent is not a productivity-theater number; it is a map of where software can give time back.

Limitations: the sample skews toward residential agents in mid-size markets, and observation itself changes behavior. We treat the percentages as directional, not precise.